DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT PORTFOLIO

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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1. INTRODUCTION

As a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, I have undertaken the Digital Literacy Project to develop and demonstrate proficiency in key digital skills. This project encompasses five comprehensive modules covering digital awareness, professional online presence, collaborative platforms, email communication standards, and cybersecurity awareness. Through this portfolio, I present evidence of my learning journey, practical applications, and personal reflections on each task. The goal is not merely to complete assignments, but to develop habits and understanding that will serve me throughout my academic and professional career.

2. TASK 1: DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

In this task, I created a one-page infographic using Canva that educates peers about digital literacy and its importance. The infographic covers five key topics: (1) What Digital Literacy means in the modern context, (2) Essential Digital Skills for B.Tech students including cloud collaboration tools and cybersecurity basics, (3) Safe Internet Practices with emphasis on password management and phishing detection, (4) Professional Online Presence strategies for building a strong digital identity, and (5) Email Etiquette fundamentals for formal academic and professional communication. The design uses a professional color scheme of blues and greens to convey trust and growth. I incorporated relevant icons, clear typography hierarchy, and meaningful statistics to make complex information digestible for first-year students. The layout balances visual elements with text, ensuring readability without clutter. What I found most interesting during this task was understanding how visual hierarchy guides attention. By using color, size, and positioning strategically, I could guide viewers through information in a logical sequence. The most challenging aspect was condensing extensive information into a single page while maintaining clarity and engagement. This exercise taught me that effective communication is about choosing what matters most and presenting it memorably, a lesson applicable far beyond infographic design.

3. TASK 2: STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

This task required establishing professional profiles on three key platforms. I created accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle—platforms essential for different aspects of my academic

and professional journey. On GitHub, I set up a profile README featuring my name, branch, current year, and a statement about my learning aspirations. This platform will serve as my technical portfolio, showcasing projects and contributions throughout my B.Tech journey. On LinkedIn, I completed my education profile with VIT Bhopal University, Computer Science Engineering, and expected graduation date. This platform will be crucial for networking with alumni, exploring internship opportunities, and building meaningful professional relationships. On Kaggle, I established my profile with relevant bio information, making it ready for data science projects and competitions that I plan to undertake in upcoming semesters. Over the next four years, I plan to: (1) Maintain consistent, professional content across all platforms, (2) Add 10+ meaningful projects to my GitHub portfolio, (3) Connect with 50+ alumni and professionals on LinkedIn, (4) Participate in Kaggle competitions to strengthen data science skills, and (5) Use these platforms as springboards for internship and career opportunities. Setting up these profiles made me realize the importance of intentionality in digital presence. Every detail—from profile photo to bio—contributes to the impression I make on potential employers and collaborators. What struck me most was how accessible senior professionals and mentors became simply by having a complete, professional profile.

4. TASK 3: CODING PLATFORMS & COLLABORATION TOOLS

For this task, I engaged with both coding platforms and Google Workspace collaboration tools. On HackerRank, I created an account and completed the "Solve Me First" beginner challenge in Python, successfully solving a simple addition problem and earning my first badge. This platform will serve as my structured learning environment for building problem-solving skills progressively. In Google Workspace, I created a comprehensive "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" containing 5 questions: 3 multiple-choice questions about cybersecurity and professional practices, and 2 short-answer questions about email etiquette and file security. The form includes automatic scoring and response tracking via Google Sheets, enabling me to gather peer feedback and assess knowledge gaps in my batch. These platforms have immense academic value. HackerRank will help me prepare for technical interviews and master programming through progressive challenges. Google Forms demonstrates my ability to create assessment tools and gather data—skills relevant to my role as Digital Ambassador and future academic/professional work. The experience demonstrated how proper platform selection enhances learning outcomes. Structured challenges on HackerRank provide immediate feedback, while Google Forms enables collaborative learning and data-driven insights.

5. TASK 4: PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION & EMAIL ETIQUETTE

I drafted two professional emails demonstrating mastery of email communication standards. The first email requests an assignment extension from a professor, structured with a clear subject line, professional greeting, context explanation, confidence statement, and proper closing. The second email expresses interest in a summer internship, including self-introduction, relevant skills, and call-to-action. Beyond individual emails, I created a comprehensive "Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist" with 8 Do's (including thinking before posting, protecting personal information, building positive digital footprint) and 8 Don'ts (avoiding sensitive information sharing, cyberbullying, posting while emotional). A critical learning moment came from analyzing a real scenario where a classmate posted a public accusation on class WhatsApp group about unequal group project contributions. This destroyed team dynamics unnecessarily. The better approach would have been private conversation first, structured team meeting second, and escalation to professor only if necessary. This scenario taught me that digital communication is permanent, powerful, and can have unintended consequences. Every message carries responsibility. Key learnings: (1) Professional communication requires clarity, brevity, and respect for the reader's time, (2) Platform selection matters—public channels should only be used when appropriate, (3) Taking 24 hours before sending emotional messages prevents regrettable communications, and (4) Your digital communication defines your professional reputation.

6. TASK 5: CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS & PREVENTION

For this critical task, I researched UPI fraud and online payment scams targeting college students. I created a detailed case study called "The Summer Internship Scam," describing how a student named Priya lost ■5,000 to a fake internship offer. The case study outlines: (1) What happened (LinkedIn scam offering internship with "verification fee"), (2) Definition of UPI fraud and step-by-step mechanics, (3) Who is targeted (college students desperate for internships), and (4) Consequences (financial loss, psychological trauma, career impact). I then created an 8+ point prevention checklist specifically for Indian college students, including: Verify company legitimacy independently, Never pay upfront for opportunities, Use strong unique passwords, Enable two-factor authentication, Never share OTPs or banking information, Research before clicking links, Be skeptical of unsolicited opportunities, and Monitor all financial transactions regularly. I also added specific guidance on financial safety, security concerns relevant to India, and contact information for National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline (1930). What surprised me most was discovering how recent

UPI fraud statistics show ■1,537 crores lost in 2023 alone, with college students representing 15-20% of victims. This isn't a rare edge case—it's affecting thousands of peers. The emotional manipulation tactics used by scammers highlighted how human factors matter more than technical knowledge in cybersecurity. As a result of this research, I've committed to a personal habit change: Before accepting any opportunity (job, internship, scholarship), I will wait 24 hours, verify independently through official channels, ask three critical questions, and involve a trusted person. This simple habit can prevent both financial loss and psychological damage.

7. CONCLUSION & OVERALL LEARNING

Completing this Digital Literacy Project has fundamentally shifted how I view my role in the digital world. It's not merely about acquiring technical skills—it's about becoming a responsible digital citizen who understands the implications of my actions online. The five modules have provided a comprehensive foundation: I've learned to communicate professionally, maintain secure digital practices, build a strategic online presence, recognize cybersecurity threats, and guide my peers toward digital responsibility. More importantly, I've internalized that digital actions have consequences. Each email I send, each platform I join, each piece of information I share contributes to either a positive or negative digital legacy. As the Student Digital Ambassador, I now feel equipped to help peers navigate the digital landscape with confidence and responsibility. The tools and knowledge I've acquired won't just serve my academic journey—they'll be foundational to my professional success in an increasingly digital world. Looking ahead, my commitment is to maintain the standards I've set: professional communication, strong security practices, ethical digital behavior, and continuous learning in this rapidly evolving field. This portfolio represents not an end point, but a beginning—the start of a four-year journey of digital growth and responsibility.

8. REFERENCES & RESOURCES

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